party PML (Q) in the 2008 general elections.[1] The escalation of this campaign seemed to be creating more enemies than it eliminated.

Baitullah Mehsud, the founder and the TTP Chief, had claimed that each drone brought him three or four suicide bombers who were usually from the families of the drone's victims (*Time*, 2009). The *Badla (Revenge)* nature of Pashtuns was being capitalised by the TTP in terms of more support and more volunteers. Ironically, Baitullah was killed in a drone attack. His successor, Hakimullah, was also targeted by drones in January 2011 and in January 2012. It is said, he managed to escape although rumour has it that he died in those attacks.

Most Pakistanis preferred Obama to Bush as the new President of the US at the time of the 2009 general election. Conversely, the frequency of drone strikes on Al Qaeda and other terrorists that lurked in FATA had risen under Barack Obama to one every four days, compared with one every 40 during George Bush's presidency.[2] Gradually, the increase in drone attacks angered the people of Pakistan. They considered it an attack on the sovereignty of Pakistan by the US: While drones were seen as a triumph of American technology in the United States, they provoked intense public anger in Pakistan. Exaggerated Taliban claims

**Table 8.1** Drone attacks in Pakistan: 2005–15.

| Year | Incidents | Killed | Injured |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2005 | 1 | 1 | 0 |
| 2006 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| 2007 | 1 | 20 | 15 |
| 2008 | 19 | 156 | 17 |
| 2009 | 46 | 536 | 75 |
| 2010 | 90 | 831 | 85 + |
| 2011 | 59 | 548 | 52 |
| 2012 | 46 | 344 | 37 |
| 2013 | 24 | 158 | 29 |
| 2014 | 19 | 122 | 26 |
| 2015 | 5 | 31 | 7 |
| 2016 | 3 | 9 | 05 |
| 2017 | 5 | 22 | 0 |
| Total* | 318 | 2,778 | 355 + |

*Data until 31 December 2017. Source: South Asia Terrorism Portal (SATP).